

District Technology Project Charter

Staff MFA and Identity Security Rollout

Project Charter: Staff MFA and Identity Security Rollout

District: Ardent ISD

Project sponsor: Deputy Superintendent for Operations

Project lead: Chief Technology Officer

Project window: September 8, 2026 - January 29, 2027

Charter status: Approved for implementation

Version: 1.0

Executive Snapshot

Ardent ISD will implement multi-factor authentication (MFA) for all staff and privileged accounts to reduce account-compromise risk and strengthen identity security. The project includes policy alignment, enrollment, training, enforcement, support, monitoring, and post-launch reinforcement. It does not include student MFA or replacement of the district's identity platform.

Ardent ISD serves approximately 8,400 students across 11 campuses and employs about 1,050 staff members.

Problem / Opportunity

The district currently relies primarily on passwords for most staff access. Password-only access creates avoidable risk when credentials are phished, reused, or exposed. The district also needs a more consistent identity-security posture for cyber-insurance, vendor access, remote work, and administrative systems.

Project Goal

By January 29, 2027, require MFA for 100% of active staff accounts and privileged administrative accounts, with documented exceptions limited to approved service or technical accounts that use compensating controls.

In Scope

- MFA configuration for staff and privileged accounts.
- Enrollment procedures and user communications.
- Pilot groups on two campuses and central office.
- Staff training, quick-start guides, and help desk scripts.
- Exception and recovery procedures.
- Enforcement schedule by employee group.
- Dashboard reporting on enrollment, support demand, and exceptions.
- Post-launch reinforcement and unresolved-user follow-up.

Out of Scope

- Student MFA.
- Replacement of the identity provider or single sign-on platform.
- Redesign of application permissions unrelated to MFA.
- Personal-device reimbursement or districtwide mobile-device replacement.
- Authentication changes for systems that cannot technically support MFA; these will be documented separately.

Major Deliverables

Deliverable	Owner	Due	Acceptance Criteria
Approved MFA configuration standard	Infrastructure Manager	Sep 25	CTO and security consultant signoff
Stakeholder communication package	Communications + CTO	Oct 2	Sponsor approval; campus leaders briefed
Pilot enrollment and support test	Systems Team	Oct 23	>=95% pilot enrollment; issues documented

Deliverable	Owner	Due	Acceptance Criteria
Staff training package	Instructional Technology	Nov 6	Video, guide, FAQ, help desk script published
Privileged-account enforcement	Systems Team	Nov 15	100% privileged interactive accounts protected
Districtwide staff enforcement	Systems Team	Jan 11	Enforcement enabled for all in-scope staff
Closeout and adoption report	Project Lead	Jan 29	KPI results, exceptions, lessons learned documented

Stakeholders

Sponsor: Deputy Superintendent for Operations

Decision owner: CTO for technical design; sponsor for districtwide enforcement dates and major scope/budget changes

Core project team: Systems, network, help desk, instructional technology, communications, HR

Key affected groups: Principals, teachers, paraprofessionals, auxiliary staff, substitutes with district accounts, central-office staff, vendors with named accounts

Budget and Resource Assumptions

Item	Planning Estimate
MFA licensing / identity features	\$24,000
Temporary support / overtime	\$8,000
Security consulting and validation	\$6,000
Training / communication production	\$2,000
Contingency	\$2,000
Total planning estimate	\$42,000

Existing staff time is not shown as a separate cash cost but is a project constraint.

Major Risks

Risk	Probability	Impact	Initial Response
Staff delay enrollment until enforcement	High	Medium	Campus-based deadlines, reminders, principal dashboard
Support spike at enforcement	High	High	Staggered enforcement, extra help desk coverage
Users without reliable personal device access	Medium	High	Approved hardware-token / alternate-factor process
Legacy application incompatibility	Medium	High	Inventory early; document exceptions and compensating controls
Confusion about account recovery	Medium	Medium	Standard recovery script and identity-verification process

Success Measures

1. 100% of privileged interactive accounts protected before districtwide staff enforcement.
2. At least 98% of active staff voluntarily enrolled before their enforcement date.
3. 100% of active in-scope staff protected within five business days of districtwide enforcement.
4. Fewer than 3% of staff require an approved exception or alternate factor after 30 days.
5. MFA-related support volume falls below 5% of weekly help desk tickets within four weeks of enforcement.
6. Staff survey shows at least 80% agree that instructions and support were clear.

Decision Authority

Decision	Authority
Routine technical configuration within approved scope	CTO / Infrastructure Manager
Schedule adjustment under 10 business days	CTO
Schedule adjustment over 10 business days	Sponsor

Decision	Authority
Budget shift within approved total	CTO + Finance
Budget increase over \$5,000	Sponsor / Finance
Major scope addition	Sponsor
Districtwide enforcement delay	Sponsor in consultation with CTO

Approval

Sponsor: Deputy Superintendent for Operations - Approved 09/04/2026

Project Lead: Chief Technology Officer - Accepted 09/04/2026

Finance Review: Chief Financial Officer - Budget planning acknowledged
09/04/2026